

In Arrah, the mutineers released all the prisoners in the jail and laid siege to Boyle's house that sheltered 16 Europeans and 45 Sikh policemen, who defended themselves for a week against constant musket fire. The mutineers even mounted a gun on the roof of a house and fired at the fortified building in an attempt to destroy it. They managed to ambush and drive away the relief force as well. Finally, the siege came to an end after a second force of the 160 Fusiliers and volunteers from the railway force defeated the mutineers.

Davidson noted that property worth £42,000 was destroyed at the Sone bridge, but that the total loss over the whole line amounted to an equivalent of three million sterling.

Fortified stations

Many, including Lord Dalhousie, had often discussed the railway's military potential. The Revolt served to drive home the point, emphasizing the importance of having key lines in strategic areas. Historian Ritika Prasad, while quoting public statements made after the Revolt, wrote, "The urgent need for more railways was emphasized in public statements about the 'all-important' ability to transport 'compact and highly trained bodies of European troops from one point of India,' and the dangers of allowing a colonized population to believe that 'on any point, whether 10 miles or at 1,000 miles away, the authority of England can be overthrown for a day by Asiatics of any race or creed'."

It was no surprise, therefore, that once the rebellion was completely quelled, work on expanding railway lines restarted at an almost feverish pace. Focus was also on ways to safeguard railway infrastructure and rolling stock. Anthropologist Laura Bear noted that there was an emphasis on developing railway stations into safe havens for British citizens in case of any future civil unrest. So much so that stations constructed after the Revolt were near cantonments. The architecture, too, started resembling forts. The terminal at Charbagh in Lucknow had an armoury and barracks, the Delhi Junction resembled a castle with turrets, and the Lahore station had bomb-proof towers and loopholes.